

Strategy : Bad Actors Modelling

Fundamentals of the strategy

What is the goal of this strategy ?

Minimize vulnerabilities from the beginning of software design through risk assessment and mitigation.

When to use it ?

This strategy can be applied during the **software design phase**, prior to any updates, during **audits and inspections**, as part of **incident response**, and while improving the software.

What is a Bad actor ?

A “**bad actor**” or “**threat actor**” is a person or group with **malicious intentions** that will try to exploit a system to achieve their own **personal goals**.

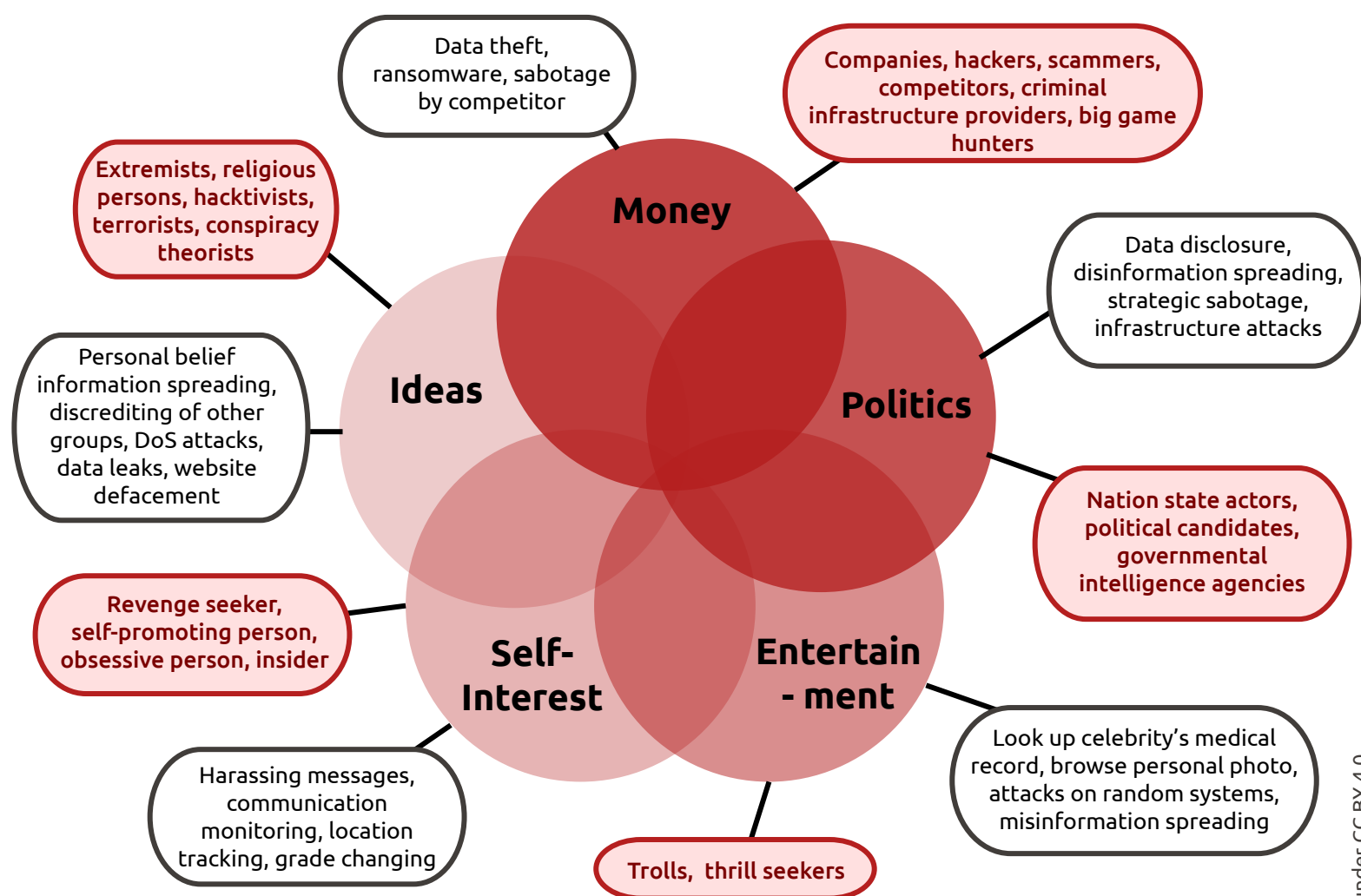
- Often external to the organization, but also insiders
- Can have unauthorized or authorized access
- Driven by **different motivations**: use the **Bad Actors Motivation Categories** below to anticipate them

Assessment questions

Who would like to use my software in a malicious way or in a way I didn't create it for ?

What would be the consequences for stakeholders ?

How could I prevent these negative consequences ?



Categories of **motivation overlap** and it is not always clear how to classify some types of actions, but it is not really important, the goal is to identify a range of possible scenarios that represent **threats** for your system (**security**) and may have negative impacts for stakeholders (**safety**).